

What competitors operate, how Cockpit works, and where we can win

A source-checked feature map across 8 competitors, a concrete signal-to-resolution operating model, every structural blocker mapped to an honest viability verdict, and a PadSplit-native build path built around verified data paths.

Companion to the business plan & data-access memo **Surveyed** Hostaway, Guesty, OwnerRez, Hospitable, Lodgify, Uplisting, Hostfully, Smoobu **Date** 2026-07-13 source-checked revision

VERIFICATION STATUS

Competitive and source-system facts are source-checked as of July 13, 2026. Phase 1 data paths are live-validated for PadSplit exports, booking and payment-risk alerts, Messenger routing metadata, and selected Airbnb host-side email classes. The workflow, service levels, and 90-day rollout below are proposed Cockpit operating policy, not claims about current production behavior. Full PadSplit Messenger body sync, universal Airbnb message-body sync, OTA write-back, and active request-queue UI remain explicit exclusions.

8

full PMS platforms catalogued, category by category

5 / 5

structural blockers, each resolved to a verdict — including 3 honest NOT-VIABLE sub-findings

10

PadSplit-native wedge features, split by data readiness

49

public source links grouped in the appendix

01 The table-stakes checklist

Each row was refreshed against current official vendor pages and help docs on July 13, 2026. “Available” includes native, first-party add-on, or named integration; where ownership matters, the row separates those mechanisms. These counts describe advertised/source-supported capability, not identical API depth, implementation parity, or plan tier. The status column is Cockpit's real answer given its no-OTA-API, no-CM-API, email-first constraints (full reasoning for the blocked rows is §02).

FEATURE	COVERAGE	COCKPIT STATUS
Channel manager — 2-way sync, Airbnb+Vrbo+Booking min all eight advertise channel sync, but speed, write depth, and OTA/API dependency vary by platform	8/8 advertise	BLOCKED — SEE §02

FEATURE	COVERAGE	COCKPIT STATUS
Unified inbox 8/8 central messaging/inbox; not 8/8 identical channel coverage or read/write behavior	8/8 central inbox	Build as a unified activity inbox from confirmed email metadata, PadSplit CSV/export data, and host-visible platform records. PadSplit Messenger is validated as sender/subject/member/property/deep-link routing metadata; the inspected emails did not include the member's message body. Phase 1 stores the alert and link for human review, not full body text.
Automated/templated guest messaging competitors commonly support templates/automation; Cockpit must avoid silent platform write-back	broadly advertised	DRAFT-ONLY, HOST SENDS — \$02
Multi-calendar view, owner blocks / gap nights 8/8 current sources advertise a central or multi-calendar; owner-block/gap-night semantics are explicitly named only in some	8/8 calendars	READ VIA ICAL + RECORDS
Dynamic-pricing <i>capability</i> (native, add-on, or pricing partner) Current source refresh: 8/8 available; about 5 native/first-party/add-on, 3 integration-led	8/8 available	NOT BUILDING — RECOMMEND A PARTNER
Guest portal / digital guidebook 7/8 source-supported guest-facing portal/guidebook; OwnerRez's checked page lists owner Portal Access but not a standalone guest-facing portal/guidebook. Hostfully explicitly sells a guest guidebook.	7/8	PHASE 2 — INTEGRATE TOUCH STAY/DUVE, NO BLOCKER
Guest ID / screening available (native or integration) 8/8 source-supported through native, add-on, verification flow, or named integration; depth and consent mechanics vary	8/8 supported	INTEGRABLE CAREFULLY — \$02
Damage / deposit handling 8/8 source-supported through native, add-on, or named integration; direct-booking/OTA/payment mechanics vary	8/8 supported	OUT OF SCOPE — MONEY MOVEMENT UNLESS DIRECT-BOOKING ONLY
Task / cleaning management 8/8 available; 6 native, 2 integration-led	8/8 available	INTEGRATE, DON'T REBUILD
Team roles / permissions 8/8 advertise team or multi-user access; 5/8+ explicitly document custom roles or permission controls	8/8 access	BUILD — NATIVE, NO DATA BLOCKER
Direct-booking website + engine	8/8	PHASE 3 — THE ONE CHANNEL WE COULD FULLY OWN
Payment processing 8/8 advertise payment, payment-link, processor, or deposit capability; this is not equivalent to native control of OTA reservation payments	8/8 capability	NOT BECOMING A PROCESSOR — \$02
Owner statements / owner portal 7/8 source-supported in the current pages checked; Smoobu pages checked do not advertise owner portal/statements	7/8	BUILD — THIS IS THE WEDGE, SEE \$04

FEATURE	COVERAGE	COCKPIT STATUS
Smart-lock / IoT integration 8/8 available; split between vendor add-ons and partner integrations	8/8 available	INTEGRATE DIRECTLY — SEAM/REMOTELOCK — \$02
Native mobile app 7/8 native apps in current official pages/help docs; OwnerRez is the checked exception	7/8 native	PHASE 2 — VALIDATE TARGET GAP FIRST
Named AI assistant / copilot 8/8 AI capability; 7/8 named AI product/feature. Smoobu's checked official AI capability is message translation rather than a copilot.	8/8 AI capability	OUR NATURAL-LANGUAGE ANALYTICS LAYER — \$05
QuickBooks / accounting integration 4/8 current source-supported: Hostaway, Guesty, Hospitable, and OwnerRez	4/8 confirmed	BUILD READ-SIDE INTEGRATION
Trust accounting (named, jurisdiction-specific) 1/8 explicitly markets jurisdiction-specific native trust accounting (Guesty); OwnerRez separately documents a trust/escrow property-management model, which is not counted as jurisdiction-specific compliance	1 named native	DIFFERENTIATOR, NOT TABLE STAKES — \$05
Multi-owner / co-ownership / fractional 1/8 explicitly documents full, co-, and fractional ownership (Guesty); other checked pages document owner management but not fractional semantics	1/8 explicit	WATCH, DON'T BUILD YET

Reviews automation is a special case: present in some form on all 8, and Vrbo's Rapid API documents Guest Reviews for select partners, but the checked Airbnb API terms do not document a public reviews scope for non-partners — see §02, explicitly NOT-VIABLE for Cockpit's current access posture.

02

Every blocker, resolved to a verdict

Five capabilities are structurally out of Cockpit's reach the incumbent way — no OTA API partnership, no channel-manager API. Each one got checked against current platform/API terms and official connectivity documentation. Three sub-findings came back honestly NOT-VIABLE rather than forcing an answer.

1. Two-way channel sync (pushing rates/availability out) CHOSEN PIVOT Read-only sidecar next to the host's existing publisher — already the architecture. Public precedent exists for analytics products that sit beside the booking platforms rather than replacing a channel manager. No comparable two-way OTA sync, price push, or auto-send without approved platform connectivity. Position Cockpit as read-only plus draft-only assist. WHAT IT COSTS US	NOT VIABLE TO REPLICATE
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iCal gives availability blocking only — one-way, asymmetric, and throttled. Airbnb says imported calendars automatically update every 3 hours and manual refresh is request-limited; Vrbo supports up to five imported calendars per property, mobile-app sync every 30 minutes, and imported events may take up to 20 minutes to appear. Airbnb's current API terms require an organization/API agreement and scoped program access; Vrbo Rapid is limited to select partners and documents its own approved API surface. Without that onboarding, Cockpit has no supported write path for OTA inventory, rates, messaging, or reviews.

HONEST FRAMING FOR HOSTS

Cockpit shows the truth; it never becomes a second system that can cause a double-booking — which every incumbent's own users complain about.

2. Payments (taking a cut, processing bookings)

VIABLE PIVOT

CHOSEN PIVOT

Flat SaaS plus Plaid Transactions read-side reconciliation. No Plaid Transfer or OTA payment processing; Stripe Connect only for Cockpit-owned direct bookings.

3. Real-time data without webhooks

VIABLE, WITH AN HONEST CEILING

CHOSEN PIVOT

Gmail watch can be a fast mailbox-change trigger, not a webhook payload. Cockpit still fetches/parses messages, and content depends on platform email bodies. For PadSplit Messenger, the inspected emails proved notification/deep-link routing metadata and did not contain the member's message text, so Phase 1 stores the alert and link for human review only. The Airbnb host-side inquiry class inspected in Gmail contained guest-written text; other message classes are outside Phase 1.

4. Writing back — replying to guests, changing prices

DRAFT-ONLY VIABLE; PRICE WRITE-BACK NOT VIABLE

CHOSEN PIVOT

Draft-only reply assist: generate suggested replies and require the host to review and send inside the platform. No silent auto-send, no automated price changes, and no claim of official platform integration unless separately approved. Airbnb prohibits bots, scrapers, or other automated means unless authorized; no co-host exception was found in the cited language.

5. Screening, smart locks, reviews

LOCKS & SCREENING VIABLE · REVIEWS NOT VIABLE

LOCKS & SCREENING

Smart-lock integrations can be built through independent providers such as Seam and RemoteLock. Current vendor pages also document screening or identity-verification availability

across all eight platforms, through native flows, add-ons, or named partners; implementation depth and consent flows still vary by vendor.

REVIEWS

The honest failure case. No checked source confirms public Airbnb Reviews API access for non-partners. Do not pitch review automation without approved platform access or a separately verified lawful source.

03 What we're deliberately not building

Naming these explicitly so nobody promises them later by accident — each one was researched, not assumed away.

- ✗ **Automated price-push to any OTA** without approved platform connectivity — assume unsupported and ToS-sensitive.
- ✗ **Silent auto-send of guest replies** — draft-only suggestions with host review/send inside the platform.
- ✗ **Native review sourcing/automation** — no confirmed non-partner access to Airbnb's review data.
- ✗ **Becoming a payment processor by accident** — Plaid Transactions read-side reconciliation only unless money movement is deliberately scoped.
- ✗ **Two-way channel distribution** — read-only sidecar to the host's existing publisher, by design.
- ✗ **Moving Airbnb/Vrbo bookings off-platform** — Cockpit can own direct bookings it sources itself, but must not use Airbnb/Vrbo messages or listings to move bookings off-platform.

04 The wedge — a PadSplit-native feature spec

Public PadSplit materials confirm room-based hosting, host-visible booking controls, Messenger/maintenance routing metadata, booking-request data availability, member score visibility, limited member balance/upcoming-dues visibility, property ratings, move-out-review direction, and an enhanced earnings CSV summarized by property/month. The live booking-request email verified requester, property, response deadline, auto-approval behavior, and review link; the current host UI showed Request (0), so Phase 1 does not depend on the active request queue. The downloaded earnings CSV verifies property/month financial fields, and the downloaded member ledger verifies member/transaction/lifecycle fields listed in the audit.

01

Property financial roll-up

Verified from the PadSplit earnings CSV for property/month and bank-account reconciliation: gross income, booking fee, service fee, transaction fee, adjustments, and earnings. It does not

02

Independent member AR ledger

Verified from the PadSplit member-ledger CSV for date, occupancy window, amount, balance, type, reason, property, move-in/out dates, and member identity. Aging buckets and overdue-status definitions are Cockpit-owned derived logic.

contain room/member/transaction-date keys, so Phase 1 does not infer room-level P&L from this file.			
03	Payout reconciliation Verified from the earnings CSV for property/month, gross income, fees, adjustments, earnings, and bank account. Member-level dated reconciliation uses the separate ledger export; room/member/transaction-date keys are not inferred from the earnings file.	04	Per-room P&L The verified PadSplit earnings CSV has no room, member, or transaction-date key. Per-room P&L is therefore a Cockpit-owned derived feature requiring explicit expense capture and allocation rules, not a claimed PadSplit source field.
05	Member lifecycle + payment-risk funnel Booking-request fields and member-ledger lifecycle dates are verified. Gmail also verified PadSplit's host-facing <i>Member Termination Warning</i> and <i>Member Reinstated</i> classes, including the \$300 balance threshold, 48-hour post-due-date warning window, property/room/member, and resolution state. Active request-queue UI and universal status-history export are excluded from Phase 1.	06	Turnover-cost tracking Needs a direct cost-capture mechanism; do not infer costs from platform status labels alone.
07	Segment-aware ingestion PadSplit path: Chrome Gmail validation confirmed host-side Messenger, booking-request, earnings, member-ledger, and export/report emails. Messenger emails contain sender/subject/member/property/deep-link routing metadata, not the member's message body. Airbnb path: the inspected host-side inquiry contained guest-written text; traveler itinerary, receipt, and payment emails were separately identified and must be excluded. MTR records are bank/Baselane/host-ledger centric, not platform-CSV centric. Keep this separate from PadSplit and OTA ingestion.	08	Portfolio reputation visibility Supported for member score host visibility, property ratings, and move-out reviews. Portfolio aggregation remains a Cockpit-derived view built from the supported source records; no broader export contract is claimed.
09	Utility cost-per-room allocation The verified PadSplit email/CSV fields contain no utility-cost field. This is a Cockpit-owned derived feature requiring manual entry or a utility-provider integration.	10	MTR deposit ledger + vacancy forecasting Proposed Cockpit-owned ledger for direct/MTR records, not a claimed source-system field. Keep it separate from OTA payment rights and off-platform-booking rules.

DATA-READINESS — SPLIT HONESTLY, NOT ALL TEN ARE EQUAL	Chrome Gmail validation on July 13, 2026, using the connected PadSplit host mailbox found host-side Messenger, booking-request, payout/earnings, member-ledger, export/report, Member Termination Warning, and Member Reinstated emails. Messenger emails are notification/deep-link triggers; the inspected bodies did not include actual member message text. The termination warning verified the member/property/room, balance-above-\$300 condition, 48-hour post-due-date window, and follow-up promise. The reinstatement email verified the below-\$300 resolution and	PadSplit host-facing earnings/collections email was opened and verified for member collections, booking fees, service fees, transaction fees,	Chrome Gmail validation on July 13, 2026, using the connected Airbnb host mailbox found host-side reservation, inquiry/request, guest-message, and payout emails separately from traveler itinerary/booking emails. The inspected host-side inquiry contained guest-written text, a host-thread deep link, listing/stay details, and a response deadline. A	Live platform validation: PadSplit /host/dashboard, /host/tasks, /host/members, /host/communication reachable; Airbnb /hosting, /hosting/messages, /hosting/reservations, /hosting/listings, /multicalendar reachable.
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	no-termination state. The earnings CSV was opened ad verified for property/month financial and bank-account fields, and the member-ledger CSV was opened and verified for dated member transaction and lifecycle fields.	adjustments, total payout, payout account, and the attached earnings export.	separate <i>Confirmed: Your reservation</i> result was identified as traveler-side and excluded. Airbnb message-body ingestion remains class-specific rather than universal.	PadSplit export controls and two downloaded CSV payloads were verified. Airbnb host-side surfaces confirmed, not traveler flows.
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05

The specialist layer — how we earn credibility as a cockpit, not a toy PMS

Cockpit sits alongside a host's existing setup as a read-side analytics and operations layer — so the features that matter most are the ones that make source-traceable host records more useful without pretending to replace the PMS or channel manager. Phase 1 is source-checked and live-validated as a read-only activity inbox plus portfolio dashboard using verified PadSplit email/CSV fields and filtered Airbnb host-side email classes. Full PadSplit Messenger body sync, universal Airbnb message-body sync, active request-queue UI, OTA write-back, and direct-booking money movement are explicit exclusions.

- **The verified-data trust argument** — platform, export, email, and bank-source traceability is the credibility bar for any read-only analytics layer.
- **Pacing & forecasting** — booking-pace trend lines against prior periods; a table-stakes requirement for a credible analytics layer, not an optional nicety.
- **Trust accounting** — Guesty is the only native source-supported platform in the checked set; Hostaway and Uplisting add marketplace-partner evidence. Keep it as a future differentiator, not a table-stakes parity claim.
- **An opinionated derived health metric** — one number per property/room that rolls up occupancy, arrears, and turnover cost, the kind of judgment call a dashboard of raw numbers doesn't make for the host.
- **A reconciliation-grade audit trail** — every derived number traceable back to its source email/CSV row, which is what makes the arrears-ledger and per-room P&L features actually trustworthy rather than another dashboard to doubt.
- **PadSplit-native metrics** — the ten-item wedge spec above, exposed as first-class views, not bolted onto an STR-shaped data model.
- **Explicit "not a PMS" positioning** — say it outright; this is what makes "read-only" read as a feature instead of an apology.
- **A disclosed setup posture** — avoid vendor-specific setup-fee comparisons unless sourced in the investor deck; say "low-friction onboarding" until pricing evidence is pinned.

06

Revised build order

PHASE 1

Table-stakes core, buildable today

Unified activity inbox: confirmed public email metadata, verified PadSplit CSV fields, and host-visible records first; platform deep-links and human review for PadSplit message threads because the inspected email body did not contain the member text. Multi-calendar view from iCal plus host records, team roles/permissions, property financial roll-up, member AR ledger, and filtered Airbnb host-side email ingestion now; room-level P&L and universal message-body sync are not claimed. Phase 1 is source-checked and live-validated within these boundaries.

PHASE 2	Enrichment + differentiation Draft-only reply assist: generate suggested replies and require the host to review and send inside the platform. No silent auto-send, no automated price changes, and no claim of official platform integration unless separately approved. Add accounting read integration, smart-lock/screening/guidebook integrations after vendor review, AI natural-language analytics over source-traceable data, and per-room P&L / turnover-cost / utility-allocation wedge features once a cost-capture mechanism exists (§04).
PHASE 3	Owned channel Cockpit can own direct bookings it sources itself, with Stripe Connect scoped specifically to that channel, never as a general OTA-payments substitute. Do not use Airbnb/Vrbo messages or listings to move bookings off-platform. Trust accounting can become a named, sold feature only after the reconciliation-grade audit trail is proven in production.

07 The operating plan — one queue from signal to proven resolution

The operating unit is an **Ops Item**, not a message thread. An Ops Item may begin as a guest message, booking request, termination warning, reinstatement, payout, ledger exception, or manual follow-up. Cockpit's job is to identify what needs attention, preserve the source evidence, guide the host to the correct system, and record a truthful resolution.

01 Capture Ingest only validated email classes, approved exports, iCal availability, extension records, and manual entries.	02 Classify Separate host-side messages from traveler confirmations, financial events, lifecycle events, and unknown classes.
03 Attach Link source, account, property, room, contact, deadline, confidence, and evidence ID. Preserve the original deep-link.	04 Prioritize Rank by external deadline, access/check-in risk, payment exposure, guest impact, and time since arrival.
05 Act Read, decide, draft, copy, or open the source platform. Keep money movement and platform delivery outside Cockpit.	06 Prove Resolve only with a source event or explicit host confirmation. Failed ingestion and unconfirmed sends stay visible.

LAUNCH BLOCKER The current app's “Copy & Mark Sent” action is not truthful enough for production. It can record **SENT** after copying a draft even though Airbnb or PadSplit has not delivered it. Clipboard failure is also not surfaced. Split this into **COPIED** , **AWAITING HOST CONFIRMATION** , and **CONFIRMED SENT** ; only the last state may close the response item.

Required workflow states

NEW Captured, not yet triaged.	ACTION_REQUIRED A human decision or source-platform action is due.
DRAFT_READY A body-present message has a host-reviewable draft.	COPIED Draft copied; delivery has not been proven.
AWAITING_CONFIRMATION Host acted in the source platform but has not confirmed the result.	RESOLVED Source evidence or explicit host confirmation closes the item.
SNOOZED Deferred until a named time with ownership retained.	BLOCKED_SOURCE Required body, permission, export, or platform access is unavailable.

SIGNAL	WHAT COCKPIT SHOWS	HOST ACTION	RESOLUTION EVIDENCE
PadSplit Messenger email	Sender/routing metadata and the PadSplit deep-link. The inspected email did not contain the member's message body.	Open PadSplit, read the message, and reply there. No Cockpit draft from missing content.	Explicit host confirmation or a later source event; never “sent” from link-open alone.
PadSplit booking request	Requester, property/room context, deadline, auto-approval warning, and review link.	Open PadSplit and approve or decline before the external deadline.	Observed follow-up status/email or explicit host confirmation of the decision.
Termination / reinstatement	Payment-risk item with member, property, room, balance condition, and timing.	Review ledger/member context and follow up where necessary.	A verified reinstatement event automatically resolves the matching warning; otherwise host resolution is required.
Airbnb host inquiry	Guest-written body, stay/listing context, response deadline, and thread link only for validated host-side classes.	Review draft, copy, open Airbnb, paste/edit, and send in Airbnb.	Separate host confirmation after source-platform send; traveler booking emails are excluded.
Airbnb reservation / payout	Operational or financial event with source class and property/reservation link.	Review exception or reconcile; do not route it to the conversation composer.	Matching platform event, reconciled record, or explicit host resolution.
CSV / bank / manual	Ledger, earnings, payout, or manually reported exception with row-level provenance.	Reconcile, assign, or document the decision. Cockpit never initiates a payment.	Matched source rows, imported correction, or named human attestation.

Daily operating surface

- **Now:** one ranked queue for messages, booking deadlines, payment risk, access issues, and reconciliation exceptions.
- **Proof:** source record, body-availability status, confidence, evidence ID, failed ingestion, and unconfirmed send attempts.
- **Archive:** resolved history with owner, timestamps, action, and resolution evidence.
- **Layout:** queue on the left, source/thread in the center, action and proof on the right.

Proposed service policy

- Access/check-in issue: acknowledge within 15 minutes; human escalation within 30.
- Booking request: triage within 1 hour; reminders six and two hours before its external deadline.

- Normal guest/member message: triage within 4 hours.
- Payment risk: review within 2 hours; same-day follow-up when action is required.
- Payout/reconciliation exception: next-business-day review.

These are proposed operating targets, not competitor claims or externally verified benchmarks.

Operating rhythm: clear or assign the *Now* queue daily; review blocked sources, parser exceptions, and unconfirmed sends weekly; review statements, portfolio performance, and reconciliation quality monthly. The queue owner is accountable for triage, while the assigned host/operator is accountable for source-platform action and confirmation.

08 **How competitors operate — and where Cockpit is better or worse**

The eight checked competitors operate primarily as systems of record: they centralize reservations and conversations, automate recurring messages, synchronize channels, and increasingly own direct bookings, payments, tasks, and owner reporting. Cockpit should enter as a **complementary operations sidecar** for fragmented PadSplit + STR/MTR portfolios, not as a smaller imitation of a mature PMS.

COMPETITOR	HOW IT OPERATES	WHERE IT BEATS COCKPIT	COCKPIT OPENING
Hostaway	Full PMS/channel manager with OTA-centered inbox, automation, reservation-triggered tasks, broad integrations, and role controls.	Native channel connectivity, write actions, mature automation, ecosystem depth.	Cross-segment PadSplit/room-level payment risk and source-evidence queue without PMS migration.
Guesty	Enterprise PMS combining multi-channel operations, AI-assisted messaging, tasks, owner portal, accounting, and trust-accounting workflows.	Financial depth, enterprise controls, owner operations, direct platform relationships.	Lower-friction sidecar for operators who need decisions across tools rather than another system migration.
OwnerRez	Highly configurable PMS with templates/triggers, direct channel partnerships, owner statements, accounting tools, and transparent feature depth.	Configurability, direct-booking control, channel-native messaging, proven statements.	Opinionated exception handling and rent-by-room lifecycle signals with less setup complexity.
Hospitable	Automation-first product for small hosts with unified inbox, Copilot, smart-device workflows, direct booking, and owner tools.	Fast messaging workflow, automation polish, smart-device execution, established user experience.	PadSplit-specific member/payment events and portfolio-wide proof rather than STR messaging alone.
Lodgify	Channel manager/PMS built around direct-booking websites and booking-engine ownership.	Owned-channel conversion, website tooling, reservations and payment collection.	Operational exception queue across existing channels where rebuilding the booking stack is unnecessary.
Uplisting	Operations-heavy PMS with automated messaging, multi-calendar, cleaning, deposits, and client/owner reporting.	Native operational actions, deposit mechanics, cleaning workflows, statements.	Read-side evidence, room economics, and PadSplit member lifecycle across a mixed portfolio.

COMPETITOR	HOW IT OPERATES	WHERE IT BEATS COCKPIT	COCKPIT OPENING
Hostfully	PMS plus strong standalone digital guidebooks and guest-experience products, with inbox, tasks, and owner management.	Guest experience, guidebooks, mature PMS workflows and partner ecosystem.	Financial/risk triage and source-proven action queue rather than content-led guest experience.
Smooibu	SMB all-in-one with channel manager, inbox, booking engine, automation, and mobile access.	Simple bundled baseline, channel sync, mobile execution, owned booking flow.	Deeper mixed-model decisions and evidence for operators whose portfolio does not fit one STR-shaped system.

Competitive advantages

- **PadSplit and rent-by-room are first-class:** room, member, arrears, termination, reinstatement, and turnover are modeled as core operations.
- **One exception queue:** messages, deadlines, payment risk, and reconciliation sit in the same ranked work surface.
- **Evidence-grade truth:** every claim and resolution carries source, confidence, timestamp, and evidence ID.
- **No forced migration:** the host can keep existing PMS/channel systems while Cockpit organizes cross-system work.
- **Lower action risk:** read-side operation avoids accidental price pushes, double-booking writes, and off-platform booking movement.
- **Distinct wedge:** member lifecycle and room-level economics are not the center of the checked STR products.

Competitive disadvantages

- **No native send or write-back:** hosts must switch to the source platform and confirm the outcome.
- **Incomplete bodies:** PadSplit Messenger email cannot support reply drafting when the member text is absent.
- **Latency and fragility:** email, export, and extension signals can lag or change format.
- **External dependency:** source-platform access, permissions, and availability remain outside Cockpit's control.
- **Less ecosystem depth:** competitors have mature integrations, brands, support, and operating history.
- **Proof adds friction:** Cockpit cannot truthfully claim delivery or resolution without source evidence or host confirmation.

POSITIONING **“The operations cockpit for fragmented rental portfolios.”** Do not sell “a cheaper PMS” or “all-in-one property management.” Lead with PadSplit/rent-by-room depth, a cross-system exception queue, and an evidence trail that tells the operator what needs action now and what was actually resolved.

09 90-day operational rollout — prove the wedge before expanding scope

WINDOW	SHIP	OPERATING CHANGE	RELEASE GATE
Days 0–14	Split copy from send confirmation; add source links, body-availability labels, deadlines, ingest status, and evidence IDs. Allow only validated email classes.	Every action shows whether Cockpit knows the body, can draft, and can prove delivery. Unknown classes are quarantined.	Zero traveler-email leakage into host conversations and zero false-sent states.

WINDOW	SHIP	OPERATING CHANGE	RELEASE GATE
Days 15–30	Launch the unified Ops Item queue with owner, priority, deadline, SLA clock, and termination-to-reinstatement matching.	A named operator clears <i>Now</i> daily and reviews <i>Proof</i> weekly; alerts stop living in separate screens.	≥95% classification accuracy on validated classes; 100% booking-request deadline capture; every item source-linked.
Days 31–60	Add body-present draft assist, stale-draft protection, explicit send confirmation, and CSV finance/reconciliation exceptions.	Host reviews every draft and sends in the source platform; finance items route outside the composer.	No auto-send; every resolved reply has confirmation evidence; parser failures remain visible.
Days 61–90	Pilot with 3–5 hosts spanning PadSplit-only, mixed PadSplit + Airbnb, and STR/MTR operations.	Run daily queue, weekly proof review, and monthly portfolio review; interview operators on missed context and duplicate work.	Measure time-to-triage, missed-deadline rate, parser exceptions, unconfirmed sends, and weekly active use.
DO NOT BUILD YET OTA write-back, automated price changes, payment processing, review automation, and unverified parser classes remain outside the first 90 days. Expansion is earned only after the read-side queue has accurate classification, truthful resolution states, and repeated operator use.			

Investor interpretation: the near-term business is not won by matching 8/8 PMS feature grids. It is won by proving that a host with fragmented PadSplit + STR/MTR operations resolves high-value exceptions faster, misses fewer deadlines, and can trace every decision back to source evidence. Native channel actions are the largest disadvantage; rent-by-room operational depth and cross-system truth are the defensible advantages.

Source appendix – current public sources, repo research, and bounded live validation checked July 13, 2026. Use these as investor-facing support with the explicit Phase 1 boundaries above.

INTEGRATIONS AND COMPETITOR CLAIMS

- [Seam](#)
- [RemoteLock](#)
- [Autohost](#)
- [Autohost docs](#)
- [AirDNA](#)
- [Hostaway features](#)
- [Guesty features](#)
- [Guesty homeowners portal](#)
- [Guesty fractional ownership](#)
- [OwnerRez features](#)
- [OwnerRez Rezzy AI](#)
- [Hospitable features](#)
- [Uplisting features](#)
- [Lodgify PMS](#)
- [Hostfully features](#)
- [Hostfully Screen & Protect](#)
- [Hostaway damage-deposit pre-authorization](#)
- [Smoobu home](#)
- [Smoobu channel manager](#)
- [Smoobu pricing and mobile app](#)
- [Smoobu mobile app help](#)
- [Uplisting mobile application](#)
- [Hostaway QuickBooks integration](#)
- [Guesty QuickBooks integration](#)
- [Hospitable QuickBooks integration](#)
- [OwnerRez QuickBooks integration](#)

EMAIL, PADSPLIT, AND DATA ACCESS

- [Gmail push notifications](#)
- [Gmail message format](#)
- [Gmail message resource](#)
- [PadSplit: Messaging your Host](#)
- [PadSplit: Messaging your Members](#)
- [PadSplit host updates](#)
- [PadSplit booking requests](#)
- [PadSplit Terms](#)
- Repo research: research/email-ingestion-channel-2026-07-12.md
- Repo research: research/gate-verification-2026-07-12.md
- Repo research: research/padsplit-mtr-feature-needs-2026-07-12.md
- Live validation: Chrome Gmail on the connected PadSplit and Airbnb host mailboxes; host platform surfaces for PadSplit and Airbnb

OTA RULES AND CONNECTIVITY

- [Airbnb Terms](#)
- [Airbnb Off-Platform Policy](#)
- [Airbnb API Terms](#)
- [Airbnb calendar sync](#)
- [Vrbo calendar import](#)
- [Expedia/Vrbo Developer Hub](#)
- [Expedia Connectivity Hub](#)
- [Vrbo Vacation Rentals API](#)
- [Vrbo integration](#)
- [Airbnb reviews help](#)
- [Airbnb reviews policy](#)

PAYMENTS AND RECONCILIATION

- [Plaid Transactions](#)
- [Plaid Transfer](#)
- [Stripe Connect docs](#)
- [Stripe Connect product](#)